

TAB 12



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-037-24/25, Version: 1

Ms. Gonez - Celebrating and Accelerating Access to Computer Science Education in the Los Angeles Unified School District (Res - 037- 24/25)(Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to preparing all students for success in college, careers, and life by equipping them with 21st-century skills;

Whereas, Computer science and coding are disciplines that foster critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving and prepare students for high-demand careers in an increasingly digital and technology-driven global economy;

Whereas, California leads the nation in open computing jobs, with 45,245 positions available as of January 2023, yet only 9,339 students graduated in computer science in 2020, underscoring a critical gap that highlights the urgent need for early and widespread exposure to computer science;

Whereas, Just 5% of California high school students are enrolled in a computer science course, demonstrating the need for broader access;

Whereas, Only 40% of California high schools offer computer science courses, well below the national average of 53%;

Whereas, A lack of qualified teachers plays a significant role in stalling efforts to expand access to computer science courses, and to address this issue, Governor Newsom signed [Assembly Bill 1251 \(Rivas, 2023\)](https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB1251) [to explore ways to streamline the process of becoming a computer science teacher;](https://leginfo.legislature.ca.gov/faces/billTextClient.xhtml?bill_id=202320240AB1251)

Whereas, The District recognizes the importance of addressing equity gaps in computer science education and supports programs like "Girls Who Code" to ensure all students, particularly girls and underrepresented groups, have access to high-quality learning opportunities;

Whereas, The District has committed to providing computer science education for all students by 2025, including ensuring every student receives 20 hours of computer science instruction annually from Pre-kindergarten to 5th grade, completes at least one rigorous and relevant computer science course in grades 6-8, and has access to a comprehensive computer science pathway in grades 9-12; and

Whereas, Schools such as Valley Oaks Center for Enriched Studies (VOCES) are leading by example, hosting events like Teen Tech Live 5.0 during this year's Computer Science Education Week, which highlight the transformative power of coding to inspire students to explore careers in technology; now, therefore be it;

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Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District reaffirms its commitment to expanding access to computer science education, particularly for underrepresented student groups, and promoting initiatives that close equity gaps in technology fields;

Resolved further, That the District acknowledges the importance of coding and computer science in preparing students for the workforce of the future and commits to integrating these skills into a well-rounded education for all students;

Resolved further, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby reaffirms and promotes the week of December 9 through 15, 2024, as Computer Science Education Week;

Resolved further, That the District provide an update during a meeting of the Board's Committee of the Whole as well as an informative on the implementation of [Board Resolution \[Res-039-17/18\]](https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/21/Res-039-17-18%20Empowering%20Todays%20Learners%20for%20Tomorrows%20Increasingly%20Digital%20World.pdf) [Empowering Today's Learners for Tomorrow's Increasingly Digital World through Access and Equity of Digital Tools and Resources \(5/8/18\)](https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/21/Res-039-17-18%20Empowering%20Todays%20Learners%20for%20Tomorrows%20Increasingly%20Digital%20World.pdf) and the District's progress toward achieving the goal of computer science education for all students by 2025;

Resolved further, That these updates shall heretofore be provided in the form of an annual report to the Board to ensure continued progress toward the equitable expansion of computer science education districtwide;

Resolved further, That the District compile and share a guide of digital resources and tools available for educators, organized thematically and by grade level, to support enhanced digital equity, the effective use of instructional technology, and expanded access to computer science instruction;

Resolved further, That the District encourages the state to continue to take steps to close the computer science teacher shortage and invest in building a diverse, qualified pipeline of computer science educators; and, be it finally,

Resolved, That the District encourages all schools, educators, and students to participate in Computer Science Education Week activities such as Hour of Code, where students have the opportunity to explore the world of coding through engaging activities, December 9 through 13, 2024.